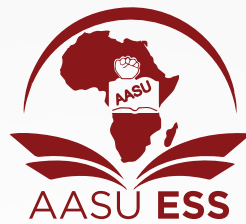




All-Africa Students Union
Union Panafricaine Des Etudiants
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفريقي

...in the students movement since 1972

ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION (AASU)

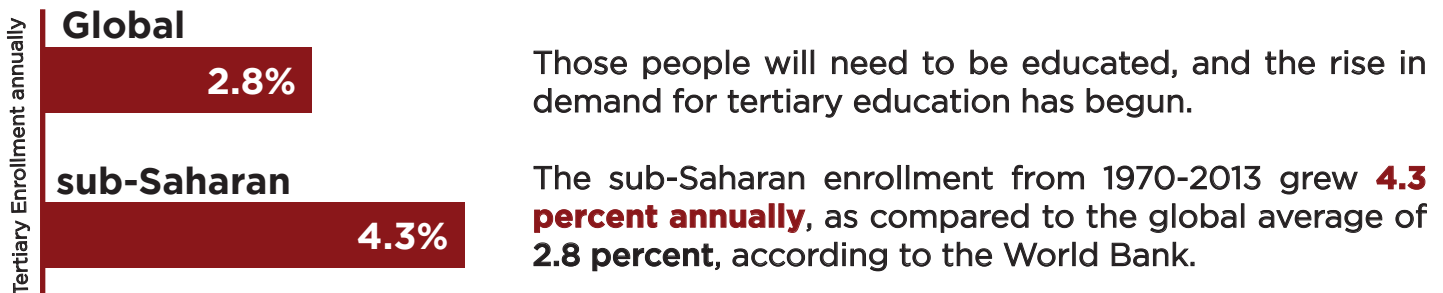


AASU EDUCATION SUPPORT SERVICES (AASU ESS)

PROPOSAL TO PROSPECTIVE PARTNERS



There is an increased demand for extra online courses and international studies by African students because of a college-aged population boom across the African continent. Foreign investment and economies are on the rise along with the population. The continent is expected to have **2.8 billion** people by **2060**, roughly 40 percent of the world's total.



Also, because of the cost of education and other constraining components, most African students or young people want to have access to cheaper or free (scholarship) education that comes with a higher comparatively “higher” level of quality.



The ten most populous countries in Africa have a combined 740 universities serving some 660 million of Africa's **1.2 billion people**, according to Quartz Africa, while the U.S. has around 5,300 universities and colleges serving a population of over 323 million people. That's a large disparity. The current number of African public institutions cannot support the growth in demand across the continent, which has led to a rapid jump in the number of private educational institutions, with the greatest rise seen in Uganda, Republic of the Congo, and Côte d'Ivoire.

Another angle of considering academic mobility is the aspect where people seek to study in other countries away from their respective countries to explore other cultures, and in some cases, run away from war or conflicts in their countries and communities. The willingness to study abroad does not only apply to Africans travelling to other parts of the globe or from one African country to another but also from the diaspora to Africa. The All-Africa Students Union (AASU) believes that in any of these cases, students are sometimes unsure of some of the decisions to make or who to consult for assistance. It is against this background that AASU intends to establish the Education Support Services (ESS).



The **AASU ESS** is intended to be a support initiative for all students across the continent who intend to pursue diverse courses in different universities across the world while making room for the opportunity to explore new places and cultures.

The AECS is a timely event that will lead to the establishment of relevant partnerships and collaborations with educational institutions that will make education more accessible to African students at all times. The AASU ESS will also include exploring online opportunities for learning and online resources.



This proposal which will be submitted to prospective partners, outlines the overall targets, sustainability measures for collaboration and engagement on the accessibility of education and educational materials. It also largely outlines the various partnerships that are required and the partnership relationships and requirements. We strongly believe that it is a great way that can increase access to education anywhere around the world, especially for Africans.

About the All-Africa Students Union

Brief overview of the All-Africa Students Union

AASU is the largest student movement in Africa and a very dominant force on the Continent and beyond. The AllAfrica Students Union (AASU) organizes all students in Africa – from the basic level to Institutions of higher learning; in essence, the Union is the umbrella organization for all students of Africa. Since its inception in 1972, AASU now has presence in **54 Countries** in Africa. As the Continent's largest students group, AASU played an important role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid.



Today, AASU is at the forefront of the fights for equal access to quality education, quality assurance in higher education, harmonization of higher education systems – with key emphasis on mobility of academics and comparability of qualifications, democratic governance, defending students' rights, promotion of gender and African culture, sustainable development, entrepreneurship, fostering of academic freedom, freedom of research and autonomy of higher institutions of learning, and the promotion of peace and democratic values, and other noteworthy objectives.



United Nations

In the year 2000, the UN awarded AASU a certificate of merit in recognition of the Union's efforts at advancing students' rights and championing the democratization of education across the African Continent. See: <http://www.un.org/press/en/2000/20000410.dev2241.doc.html>

AASU is wholly student-run and student-led, autonomous, representative, democratically elected and operates according to democratic principles. The Union has a democratically elected leadership from the various African countries and the executive structure is representative of all the sub-regions – our structure is very much like that of the African Union. We are in the process of establishing sub-regional offices to decentralize and complement efforts of the Headquarters in Accra-Ghana.

AASU's key strength lies in its diversity and numerical strength; which it employs as a bargaining tool to speak for the supreme interests of students at all times. The Union is made up of diverse students, regardless of their religion, gender, cultural background, political persuasion, ethnic origin or social standing.

The Headquarters

The Union is headquartered in Ghana under a headquarter agreement with the Government of Ghana, the principal donor of the Union. The Secretariat, which is the headquarters of the Union, is the statutory governing body under the All-Africa Students Union (AASU) tasked with the responsibility of running the day-to-day activities of the Union, and acts as the Union's operative arm in between Congress (the highest organ of the Union). The Secretariat is headed by the Secretary-General and supported by other elected officials from different countries and a technical staff seconded by the Government of Ghana.

The Union achieves its core mandate through:

Advocacy

The Union campaigns actively in defense of students' rights, and the passage of policies on the need for the democratization of education across the Continent, with emphasis on access, equity, and equality.

Capacity Development

The Union facilitates education and training to build the capacities of students through conferences, seminars, training programs, and educational materials to enhance the potential of graduates to access decent jobs, develop their leadership skills and significantly improve their skill sets

Networking

The Union creates the platform and environment for networking amongst members aimed at building closer relations for healthy partnerships

Partnerships

The Union constantly seeks out collaborative partnerships with like-minded organizations to work together to advance progressive agendas

The Vision of the AASU ESS

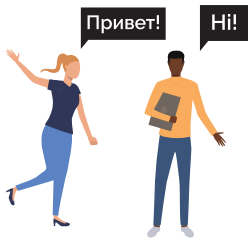
The overall vision of the AASU ESS is **to establish a center at the AASU secretariat that provides education support services and learning opportunities for African students.**

Specific Objectives of the AASU ESS

The specific areas of consideration for the AASU ESS include but are not limited to:

- Be a hub for research on matters concerning access to education
- Provide consultancy services to students and prospective students on courses offered in schools
- Serve as a liaison between students and academic institutions with respect to education enrolment
- Provide online learning opportunities for students

Key Services



1. Exchange programmes

The goal of the exchange programmes is to promote inter-culturalism and lifelong learning while promoting exploratory learning among students.

The exchange programme is a great way for students to learn and appreciate the diverse

nature of the world and how they can play a key role in addressing the challenges and opportunities that are widespread globally. Promoting such opportunities and bringing them closer to the African student is a great step in exposing the next generation of Africa to the world.

A peculiar aspect of the program is to create and maintain an online platform through which students from Africa can maintain contact with students from other African and non-African countries to pursue shared goals, research papers, etc. It is also expected that students may not necessarily have to move away from their home countries but be able to stay in their home countries and receive tuition on different courses from teachers in other institutions while collaborating with students from different countries on diverse assignments.

Foreign exchange programs provide students with an opportunity to study in different countries and environments, experiencing the history and culture of other countries, as well as meeting new people to enrich their personal development. International exchange programs are also effective to challenge students to develop a global perspective on diverse subject matters. The **AASU ESS** intends to **collaborate** with Pre-Tertiary and Tertiary institutions to find distinct program schedules or models that work within distinct contexts. This program is also expected to feed into efforts to harmonize education.



2. Senior and junior high schools studying opportunities.

The ESS also seeks to explore learning opportunities both within and beyond the borders of the African continent for students at the Senior and Junior High School levels. The exposure and unique opportunities for learning prior to entering the tertiary levels can be key in shaping the way young people approach the choice of courses or career paths. The end goal is to allow young people to explore while preparing adequately for progressive learning and new knowledge at the tertiary level.





3. Online Classes

The AASU ESS is also expected to run online short courses and workshops for the African student by partnering with other institutions. The idea is to be able to provide learning opportunities for individuals at little or no costs to the learner while gaining relevant knowledge in diverse areas. The All-Africa Students strongly subscribes to lifelong learning. We believe, this opportunity, if well executed will benefit lots of students who cannot in the interim afford to attend any institution. Through the partnership with these institutions, they can apply for the courses and receive an official certificate.



4. Training and Short courses

The training and short courses will focus on Technical Vocational Education and Training (TVET) and technology-related programs or courses. With the coming coming into being of African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), there is and will be a call for very skilled individuals. It is also expected that these individuals will have sought after skills peculiar to the African context. Some of these courses may include but not limited to event planning, carpentry, architecture, and graphic designing.



5. Available Scholarships

The ESS will make available scholarship opportunities available to all students across the continent on a fair and equal basis. The basic tenet of the ESS is to reach out to the many students spread out across the African region who do not have relevant skills and cannot afford to pay the increasing costs of higher education to attain and develop these skills.



6. Summer programmes

This service rendered by the union will also focus on promoting lifelong learning opportunities for all students across the continent. Summer programs opportunities based on the academic schedules of educational institutions will be shared with all students, not only through social media platforms but through on-site means as well. It is important to note that the ESS Secretariat will assist students who do not have the enabling technologies to successfully submit their applications for such programs.



7. Degree, Masters and Ph.D. programmes

The ESS initiative will also have a priority of making available opportunities for higher learning at the degree, masters and PhD levels based on the partnerships with universities spread across the world.



8. Aprehenticeship and Mentorship programs.

These programs will include those run by the All-Africa Students Union, its partners or those run by other organisations. The mentorship programs will be geared towards equipping students with real-life work experiences, communication skills, teamwork, intercultural exchanges, and the like. Based on organizational differences and goals, these programs will be designed to suit the interests of all students.



9. Opportunities for African culture/skill initiative

The AASU ESS is also expected to provide African students with great initiative an opportunity to sell Africa's creativity to the world. One of the basic tenets of this initiative is to empower the young African to embrace and understand his or her culture, and in so doing, build a skill, brand or product that is worth exporting to the rest of the world. This could be possibly be attained through engagement with African Studies Institutes, public lectures, workshops, cultural festivals, among others.

Constitution of the AASU ESS Board

- AASU Secretary-General
- The AASU Chief Operating Officer
- Reps from partner institutions
- A nominated member from a National Student Union within Africa

Constitution of the AASU ESS Board

The proposal from AASU to prospective partners includes but not limited to the following;

1. Work together to develop contextualized exchange programmes that will be of immense benefit students
2. AASU will provide assistance to organize both online and onsite information sessions for partner institutions across the African continent
3. AASU will be committed to getting students enrolled in the partner educational institution while considering the available scholarship opportunities
4. AASU, upon the agreement that will be reached with the partner institution, will take some commission for the liaison work that it will be doing for the students of Africa
5. Partner agencies or institutions will be expected to communicate scholarship and other opportunities to AASU to be communicated to students



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